

FIU Scholarship Commons: The Institutional Repository (IR)

<https://digitalscholarship.fiu.edu/>

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Accessibility Requirements for Repository Submissions

New or updated PDFs and other documents must meet WCAG 2.1 AA Accessibility requirements

Florida International University is committed to providing equitable access to its digital resources. Documents submitted to the Institutional Repository must be accessible to individuals who use screen readers, keyboard navigation, magnification software, and other assistive technologies.

NEW!

Although accessibility obligations already exist under the Americans with Disabilities Act and Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act, the U.S. Department of Justice's updated Title II rule establishes **WCAG 2.1 Level AA** as the **required** technical standard for state and local government web content and mobile applications.

Newly posted or updated documents must meet these requirements now if they are to have continued access in the repository after the April 2027 deadline. **A pdfa/2u is the recommended document format.**

Accessibility Formatting

Before submitting a document, authors should ensure that it includes:

- searchable and selectable text
- properly structured headings, lists, and tables
- alternative text or equivalent descriptions for meaningful images, charts, and figures
- a logical reading and tab order
- meaningful hyperlink text
- sufficient color contrast
- captions or transcripts for embedded multimedia
- accurate document properties, including the title and language

Authors should run the accessibility checker in the program used to create the document and review all issues requiring manual inspection. Passing an automated checker alone does not guarantee that a document is fully accessible. Use the following resources to help prepare your document for submission:

Resources for Creating Accessible Documents

- [FIU: Creating Accessible Content](#)
- [Section508.gov: Creating Accessible Word Documents](#)
- [Section508.gov: Creating Accessible PDFs](#)
- [Microsoft: Creating Accessible Office Documents](#)
- [Microsoft: Creating Accessible PDFs](#)
- [Adobe: Creating and Verifying PDF Accessibility](#)
- [U.S. Department of Justice: Title II Web Accessibility Rule](#)

Documents that do not meet accessibility requirements may be returned to the submitter for correction, and publication may be delayed or withheld until identified barriers are resolved. If accessibility concerns are discovered after publication, the document may need to be corrected, replaced, or temporarily restricted while an accessible version is prepared.

Inaccessible university content may expose FIU to disability-discrimination complaints, federal investigation and monitoring, mandatory remediation, litigation, and responsibility for legal fees. Therefore, submitters are responsible for preparing and correcting their documents in accordance with the new regulations mentioned above.

The repository manager can help identify accessibility issues and provide guidance, but they cannot complete extensive document remediation on an author's behalf. Author certification of accessible documents during the submission process helps the library support the university's compliance requirements.

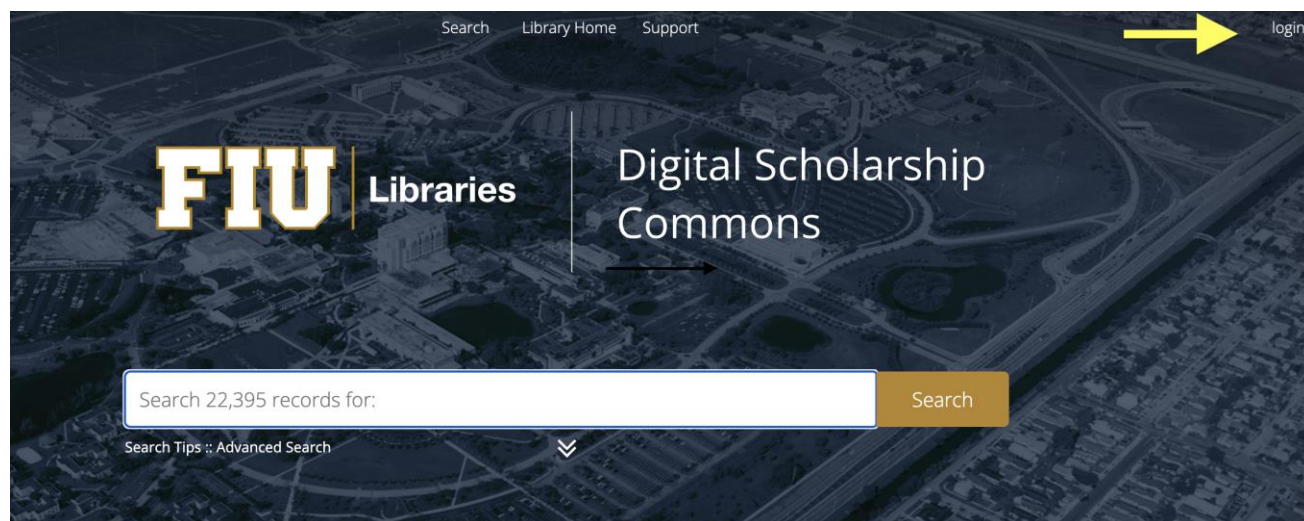
Submitting to a Collection in the IR

***IMPORTANT!**

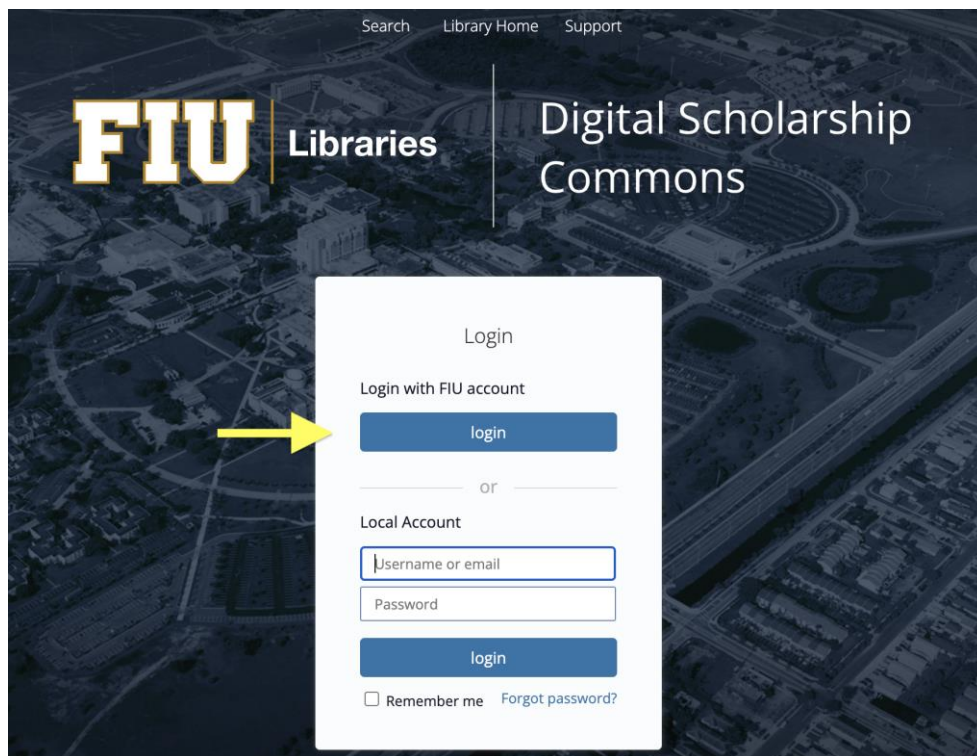
Please do not create more than one DOI for the same record or submit the same article more than once. To correct, replace, or update a previously submitted document, or for help with any other issue, please contact dcc@fiu.edu.

Step 1: Signing in to the IR

FIU's Digital Scholarship Commons can be found here: <https://digitalscholarship.fiu.edu/> . In order to submit to the IR, you will first need to sign in.



If you are part of the FIU community, sign in using your FIU credentials. If you are an outside partner, use the local account details that were emailed to you.



Search Library Home Support

FIU Libraries | Digital Scholarship Commons

Login

Login with FIU account

login

or

Local Account

Username or email

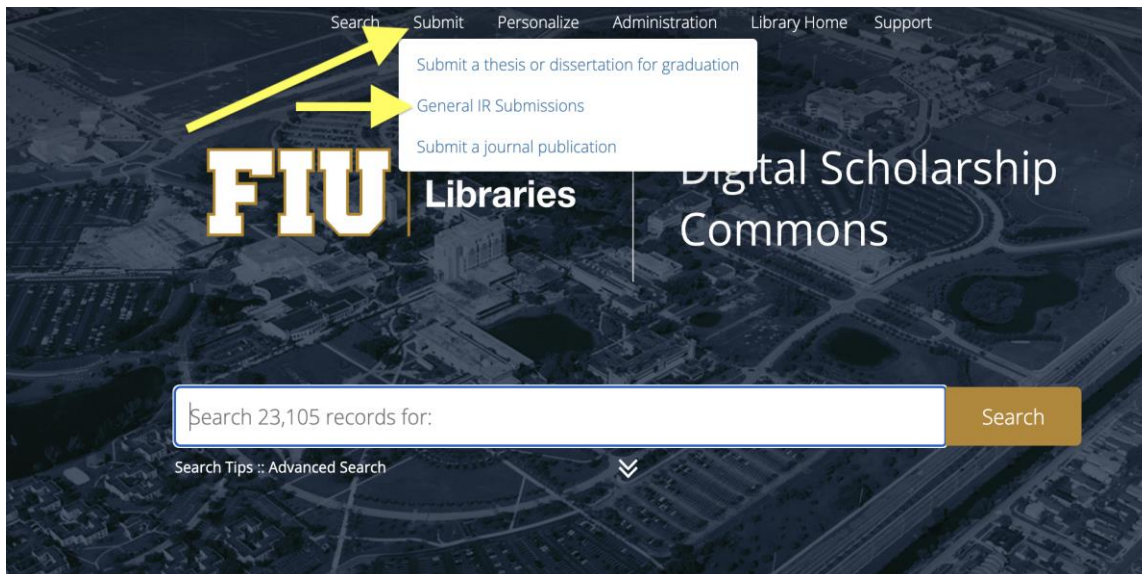
Password

login

☐ Remember me [Forgot password?](#)

Step 2: Finding the submission forms

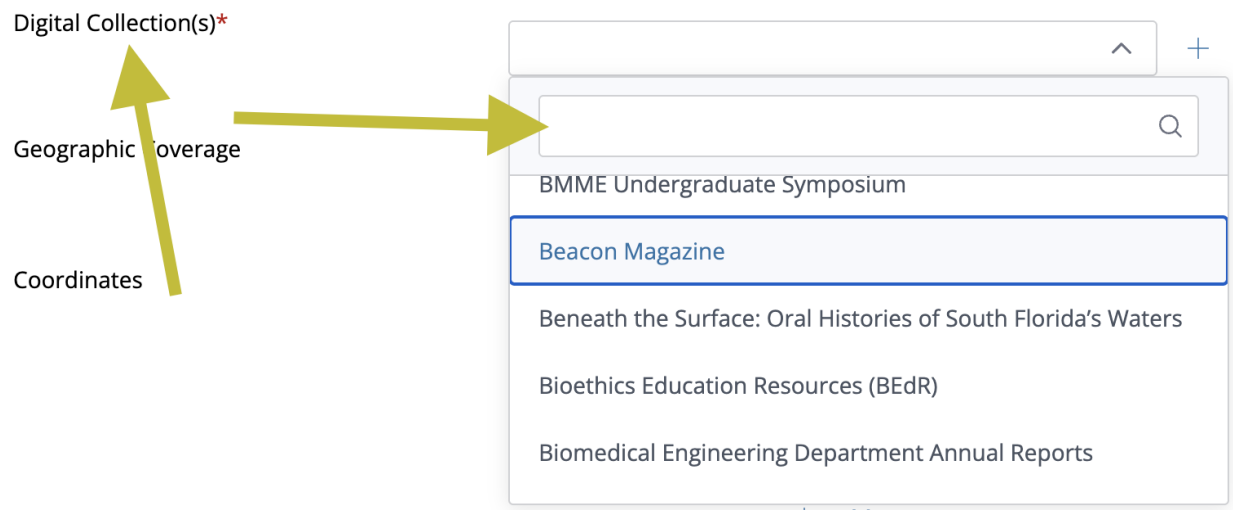
Once you are logged in, select “Submit” from the top or hover over it to find the “General IR Submissions” where you will begin your submission process.



Step 3: Filing out the form

Please note:

- Not all fields are required, but those that are required will have a red asterisk next to them. Enter as much metadata or as little as you prefer. The more fields you fill out, the more discoverable your work is likely to be.
- Be careful to choose the correct digital collection for your work. Most departments manage the content in their collections and may ask to have a randomly appearing work deleted from their collection, so be sure you have permission to upload to a specific collection.
- The drop down is an alphabetical listing of collections. You can also type in the name of the collection in the search bar to find your collection faster.



- You will notice two DOI (digital object identifier) fields. The first one is for entering a pre-existing DOI already assigned to your work. If you have a pre-existing DOI, do not create a new one.
- The second DOI field is for those that need to create a DOI. Choose “yes” from the dropdown if you require a DOI for your work.
- DO NOT create a second DOI if you update or reload the same article (this requires our assistance). This will cause some DOIs that point to your work to become a broken link and make your work less discoverable.

Example of entry for creating new DOIs:

Generate DOI

Choose “Yes” only for original, citable scholarly outputs. Do not assign a DOI for drafts or administrative materials.

The screenshot shows a dropdown menu for the "Generate DOI" field. The dropdown is open, displaying a single option: "Yes". The dropdown has a light blue border and a small upward-pointing arrow in the top right corner.

Step 4: Submission

- Once you have completed the form, attach your work.
- While the attachment box says that it accepts “all types”, for documents, it is **strongly recommended that you upload a pdfa/2u** to meet accessibility requirements.
- After submission, it may take the system up to 20 minutes to populate your work into the collection. Please check the collection (rather than the dashboard) to view your work and contact us at dcc@fiu.edu if you experience any issues.

Indexing Timelines

Once your work is published in the institutional repository, the time it takes for google scholar to index a new submission varies. Below is a list of general timelines for indexing:

- **For established & high-authority Publishers (1 to 4 weeks):** Major publishers like Elsevier, Springer, or IEEE are heavily prioritized by Google's crawlers. Articles published here often appear within a few days to a month.
- **Institutional Repositories & Trusted Journals (4 to 8 weeks):** For well-configured repositories like TIND IR or journals hosted on platforms like Scholastica, the initial crawling and validation process generally takes 4 to 8 weeks.
- **Brand New Journals or Domains (6 to 9 months):** If a repository or journal website is brand new, Google Scholar proceeds cautiously to verify that the site is a trusted academic source. This initial trust evaluation can stretch the wait time to 6–9 months.